



PLAYBACK MUSIC

Check out some keyboard shortcuts and plugins you just cannot do without, create new skins, burn your music files onto CDs and more

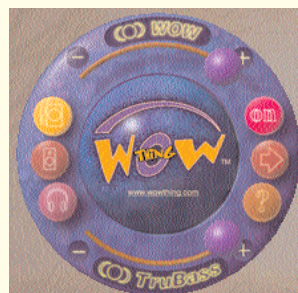
Must-have plugins for Winamp

What sets apart Winamp from other MP3 players is the large number of plugins available that extend its capabilities.

Wowthing DSP plugin

Winamp provides you with some default equaliser options, but there is no actual boost in terms of sound quality. Wowthing enhances the sound quality through its sound boosting abilities, which include Trubass for bass adjustments and Wow for treble. Snag it from

www.riopart.com/software/WoWThing.exe.



Wowthing: For audiophiles looking to tweak their Winamp beyond the normal equaliser pulgins

SoftAmp VirtualSound

If you cannot afford a four-point surround sound speaker, you can simulate



Winamp Keyboard Shortcuts

Right-click the Winamp title bar and choose About Winamp or press [Alt] + [F] + [W] to bring up a list of more than 50 keyboard shortcuts. Here are some important ones:

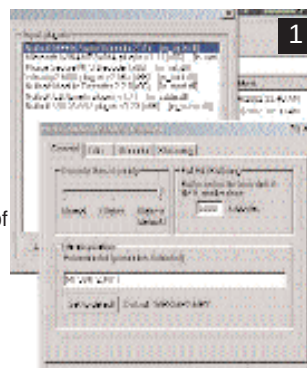
[Alt] + [F]	Brings up the main menu
[J]	Jump to file
Up and down arrows	Adjust the Volume
Left and right arrows	Fast forward or rewind the song
[Z], [X], [C], [V], and [B]	Previous Track, Play, Pause, Stop, Next Track
[Shift] + [V]	Stop playback and fade out
[Ctrl] + [Tab]	Cycle between all open Winamp windows
[Ctrl] + [P]	Brings up the Preferences
[Alt] + [S]	Brings up the skins menu

TROUBLESHOOTING

Solutions to some common problems you might be facing with your Winamp

Why is Winamp's output jittery?

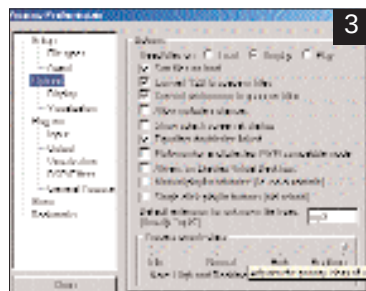
There could be several reasons why your Winamp output stutters or jumps. It may be due to an aging computer, too many processes, fragmented hard-drives, and so on. If the quality of MP3 playback means the world to you, just follow these steps to listen to music smoother than a well-aged Chardonnay.



1. Go to **Winamp > Preferences > Input**, and select the MPEG audio decoder. Increase the thread priority to the highest. Increase the Full File Buffer to 6000 Kilobytes. This will make Winamp load the entire song if it is smaller than that.



2. Go to **Winamp > Preferences > Output**, and increase the buffer length to 10,000 ms. Set priority to Time Critical.



3. Go to **Winamp > Preferences > Options** and increase the Process Priority Class to Realtime.

Try these settings and give it a test run. Now open Photoshop, 10 browser windows, and a dozen applications to see if it stutters. Most likely it won't.

Winamp's volume controls don't work on my system

Open the Preferences window and select Plugins/Output. Select Nullsoft waveOut Plugin and click Configure. Look for a little checkbox labelled Alt setting mode. Check it, click OK, and close the Preferences window. Now play some music and try out your new volume controls.

it with this wonderful plugin. This DSP plugin allows you to position four virtual speakers (two woofers and two tweeters) around a virtual person on the screen. For audiophiles who cannot afford high-end speakers and have to deal with clunky headphones or speakers, this one's definitely

handy. It's yours at www.softamp.com.

X-Plugin

X-Plugin is one of those funky plugins. It has 15 speakers (yes you read it right, it is 15) neatly placed around your Winamp. The speakers can be docked anywhere on the desktop, with some cool looking